

Family Recipe Cookbook

Getting Started

Remember, settle, and save what matters.

EverReady Family

Getting started

Welcome — and thank you. You have just done something your family will thank you for at every holiday table from here on: you started saving the recipes.

Here is the whole idea. Somewhere in your family there is a card box, a tin, a drawer of recipe cards in handwriting nobody wants to lose — Grandma's dressing, your mother's rolls, the card with the coffee stain that means it was the good one. The Family Recipe Cookbook turns those cards into a printed-ready family cookbook: the original card on the left page, the recipe clean and readable on the right, gathered in sections by the family member who shared them.

This short guide walks you through your part. It is small on purpose: photograph, confirm, done. We handle the rest.

How it works

1. You invite your contributors. Each family member gets a private link — no accounts, no passwords. A sister across the country needs nothing but her phone.
2. Each person photographs their cards. One card per photo, front and back (recipes love to continue on the back). The next page has the whole photographing method — it takes a minute to learn and saves everybody a second round.
3. We transcribe every card into a clean, standardized recipe: ingredients in order, steps numbered, servings and temperatures where the card gives them.
4. The person who submitted each card checks the transcription against their photo and confirms it. Only then does a recipe enter your book. Nobody else can confirm it for them — that is what makes the whole family trust the text.
5. Your finished book arrives as a print-ready PDF, and bound printed copies can be ordered on top of it (page 6).

Photographing cards so they read forever

Good photographs are the whole ballgame — every smudge we can see clearly is a recipe saved exactly right.

- Flat and straight-on. Lay the card on a plain table and hold the phone directly above it, not at an angle. Angles shrink the far edge and curl the words.
- Honest light. Bright room light or shade by a window. No flash glare across the pencil — faded pencil disappears under a flash.
- One card per photo, and fill the frame. Get close enough that the card nearly fills the picture. Front AND back: turn it over even if the back looks blank — continuations hide there.
- Cards written out over several cards are fine — photograph them in order and tell us in your confirmation that they go together.

If a photo is too blurred to read, we will say so and ask for a retake. Better a retake now than a question mark forever.

The confirm promise: we never guess

Handwriting — especially cursive, especially pencil — hides traps. A 1 that is really a 7. A quarter-teaspoon that is really a quarter-cup. Get one of those wrong and the dish is ruined — worse, someone at the table says that is not how Mom made it.

So we never guess. Anything we cannot read with certainty comes back to the person who submitted the card flagged like this: 1 [?] tsp soda. The flag names exactly what needs eyes. Quantities, temperatures and times get flagged on any doubt at all.

Old words get respect, not erasure. When a card says oleo, the clean text reads margarine and carries a small editor's note — 'Card says oleo' — which the contributor can keep or remove. 'A pinch' and 'bake till done' stay exactly as written: vague-on-purpose is information too.

A recipe locks only when its own contributor confirms every reading. Unconfirmed recipes cannot enter the book — not by the organizer, not by us. The photo always prints beside the text, so anyone can check the two against each other, forever.

Your finished book

Your book is built at 8.5 by 11 inches — big enough for old cards to read at arm's length in a working kitchen, and the size your printed copies use.

Inside: a cover with your family name; a page explaining how the book was made (your grandchildren will ask); a page for the contributors; then the recipes in sections by the person who shared them — Mom's Cards, Aunt Mary's Box — each recipe on its own spread, card photo left, clean recipe right. An alphabetical index and blank Notes & New Favorites pages close the book, ready for the next generation's additions.

The file you receive is print-ready: it is the same interior that bound copies are printed from, so what you see on screen is what arrives in the mail.

Printed copies, and copies for the family

The digital build you purchased includes your print-ready PDF. Bound printed copies — perfect-bound, premium color, kitchen-durable — are \$49 each, and the digital build is included with the first bound copy.

A cookbook is the rare family treasure that sells once per family member, not once per family. Extra bound copies for siblings, kids, grandkids and the cousins who submitted cards are \$29.95 each. A book like this belongs in every kitchen that ever smelled the original cooking.

When printed copies open for ordering, your book's page is where you will place them — one order per copy, shipped straight to each address. Print production takes a few weeks; order ahead of reunions and holidays.

A note on old recipes, and what else we keep

These recipes are reproduced as family history, exactly as your family wrote them. One care: home canning and preserving guidance has changed over the years. For canning and preserving, follow current USDA guidance — keep the card for the memory and the modern method for the pantry.

The cookbook is one leg of EverReady's Family Heritage set: the Life Story Interview Kit (\$37) keeps their voice — you had the talk, now keep the story — and the Family Photo Archive (\$49) keeps the photographs that go with both. Food, voice, and pictures: together they are the parts of a person a family actually reaches for.

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— EverReady Family